FREE HOBBY STARTER KIT

Hiking

For the grown-up · read this first, then hand over the mile log

Hiking is the most gear-optional hobby in this kit: a pair of comfortable shoes and a nearby park count as a trail every bit as much as a mountain does. The mile log turns ordinary walks into a collectible achievement — distances add up week after week, and the trail checklist gives every walk a reason.

How to make the first walk stick

- **Start embarrassingly short.** A 30-minute loop that ends with a snack beats a two-hour trudge that ends with complaints.
- **Walk on foot paths, not roads,** whenever you can, and tell kids the "stay near the grown-up" rule before leaving, every time, boring-briefly.
- **Pack pockets, not permits:** water, a snack, phone or small first-aid bits — that's a real kit bag. Anything more happens after the third walk became a routine.
- **Let the destination be the treat** (a pond, a bench, an ice cream shop on the route) — it makes the return half of the walk cooperative.

> **Weather logic:** light rain with the right clothes is as fun as sunshine and empties the trail. Heavy wind, ice, or storm forecasts are the honest no-go lines — cancel without guilt, reschedule for a new date.

The no-gear rule

Walking shoes and water only. If walks start coming regularly, map a habit of photographing the trailhead each time — it makes the log's "trail photo" memory box easy. No boots required for any of the first ten walks.

Page 2 is the hiking log; page 3 turns miles and trails into a progress map.

Hiking Mile Log

One row per walk. A walk around the block counts — distance is distance.

DATE	TIME START / END	TRAIL OR PARK NAME	MILES	WEATHER	BEST MOMENT	HOW IT FELT (1–5)

Total miles so far

Write the running total in the box. Round up for the feeling of progress; keep the real half-miles off the record for honesty.

Things to look for on any trail

- Something older and smaller: a stone
- Something older and bigger: a tree
- Water running, or a sign it sometimes does
- Animal signs: holes, tracks, eaten leaves
- The best smell — name it

> **Snack rule of hiking:** pack twice the snacks you think you need. In the log above, if the "best moment" column is empty, it was probably food-related.

Trails Ticked

Twelve rows = twelve different places to walk. Repeats count too; the goal is filling every row by the end of the season.

#	PLACE	DATE	SOMETHING WE SAW	AGAIN?
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				

Six places I want to find

- ☐ A trail near home we can start from the front door
- ☐ A trail with a view of water
- ☐ A trail that crosses a bridge or boardwalk
- ☐ A trail with hills we can complain about loudly
- ☐ A trail that ends at something (ruin, monument, pond)
- ☐ A trail we've never tried at all

> **Milestone moments:** when total miles on page 2 pass 10, 25, and 50, mark it on this page and treat it. Print more copies of both pages as the collection grows.